

Identify parent functions and their key features

Pre-Cal | CK-12: Function Families

Key Idea

A **parent function** is the simplest member of a family — no shifts, stretches, or reflections. Learn each shape and one key point.

Key Terms

- **Parent function** — the base graph of a family
- **Domain** — allowed x ; **Range** — resulting y

Worked steps

Step 1: Read the rule and name the family.

Step 2: Recall its shape, key point, and domain.

Example: $f(x) = \sqrt{x}$ is the **square-root** parent; it starts at $(0, 0)$ and only exists for $x \geq 0$.

You Try

Name the parent of $f(x) = \frac{1}{x}$ and state its domain.